Leftover Bytes

(Discovery & Initial Planning)

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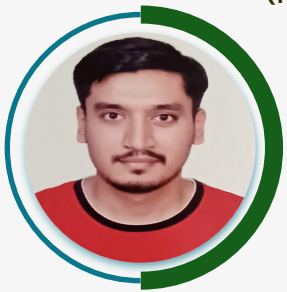

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(Content Lead)

Problem Definition & Impact

Problem Statement

- Large amounts of leftover food from campus events go to waste due to the lack of a quick, organized redistribution system.
- Event hosts struggle to find students to take the leftover food within the short time frame available.
- Students interested in free food miss out due to a lack of visibility and timely communication.

Why it Matters?

- **Food Waste Reduction**: Prevents unnecessary food waste and promotes sustainability
- **Student Benefits**: Offers free food to students, helping alleviate food insecurity and reducing meal costs.
- **Operational Efficiency**: Enables event organizers to efficiently distribute extra food without waste.
- **Community Engagement**: Strengthens connections between students and event hosts by creating a shared platform for food redistribution.

Potential Impact

Short-Term Impact:

- Immediate redistribution of leftover food within CDS events (~4 food events/day).
- Encourages student participation and engagement with campus events.

Long-Term Impact:

- Expands beyond CDS to the entire campus, benefiting a larger student population.
- Contributes to BU's sustainability initiatives by reducing food waste at scale.
- Possible collaboration with BU Facilities, Catering, and Event teams for broader adoption.

Stakeholders & End Users

Primary Stakeholders:

- **CDS Staff, Administrators & Facilities Teams** – Key partners managing events and food redistribution on campus.
- **BU Catering** – Already engaged in food waste reduction efforts, offering possible integration opportunities.

End Users:

- **Event Hosts** – Professors, administrators, & program coordinators ordering food from external vendors who need an easy way to redistribute leftovers.
- **Students** – Those looking for free food and available to pick up leftovers quickly, reducing waste while benefiting from extra meals.

Potential Collaborators:

- **Student Organizations** – Campus groups that frequently host events and can leverage the platform to manage surplus food.
- **BU Sustainability Initiatives** – University-led programs focused on reducing food waste and promoting environmental responsibility.

Unified Communication Plan

Daily Updates

- **Whatsapp**
  Quick updates,
  Instant messaging,
  Designate a daily lead

Weekly Updates

- **In-Person**
- **Google Meet**
  Team sync,
  Decision-making,
  Include agenda items & Brainstorming

As needed

- **Email**
  Official communication,
  Detailed documentation,
  Formal updates

Documentation

- **Google Drive**
  Updated regularly,
  Central hub for all documents

Team Sessions

- **Brainstorming -** Open discussion to generate & refine early ideas.
- **Sync-Up Session -** Quick check-in to stay aligned and on track
- **Retrospective -** Open chat on what worked well and what needs improvement.

Key Focus & Next Steps

Leftover Bytes

Stakeholder Collaboration

Work with CDS, BU Catering, and Facilities to simplify food redistribution.

Real-Time Food Sharing

Enable event hosts to instantly list available leftovers and notify nearby students.

Seamless Pickup Coordination

Use Wi-Fi tracking to match available food with nearby students.

Sustainability & Awareness

Reduce food waste while promoting sustainability and community engagement across campus.

Pilot Testing

Test core features at ~4 CDS events/day.

Stakeholder Engagement

Schedule follow-up meetings with CDS, BU Catering, & Facilities to refine collaboration and integration details.

User Feedback

Develop and deploy a strategy for gathering early user feedback on usability and functionality.

Roadmap Development

Outline a phased development plan prioritizing the MVP feature set and integration milestones.

Thank You!